

Victoria Cross



Victoria Cross

The Victoria Cross is awarded for bravery or some daring act of valor, self-sacrifice, or extreme devotion to duty in the presence of the enemy

It was introduced on January 29 1856 by Queen Victoria to honor acts of valor during the Crimean War

It is the highest and most prestigious award of the British honors system and has been awarded to 99 Canadians (WW1 - 73, WW2 - 16)

Since WW2 it has only been awarded 15 times. 11 to British soldiers and 4 to Australian soldiers

There is a rumor that the medals are made from old russian cannons that were captured in a famous battle during the Crimean War but historians say they are made out of 1914 cannons from China

The medal was awarded by the british military to any members of the commonwealth (former territory of the British empire)

Canada now has its own Victoria Cross which was established in 1993, but no one has been awarded one yet.

Wallace Lloyd Algie

Wallace Lloyd Algie was born on 10 June 1891 in Alton, Ontario. In April 1916 he enlisted in the 20th Infantry Battalion, Canadian Expeditionary Force. Lieutenant Algie was awarded the Victoria Cross for his conduct on 11 October 1918 during the final day of the advance to Cambrai, France by the Canadian Corps. When his troops came under heavy machine gun fire from a nearby village, Algie rushed forward with nine men and disabled the crew of one machine gun, and then turned it on the enemy. Continuing to advance into the village with his party, he attacked a second machine gun, killed its crew, and captured an officer and ten men, thereby clearing the eastern end of the village. Lieutenant Algie was killed later that day while returning to the village with reinforcements.

Citation

"For most conspicuous bravery and self-sacrifice on the 11th October, 1918, north-east of Cambrai, when with attacking troops which came under heavy enfilade machine-gun fire from a neighbouring village.

Rushing forward with nine volunteers, he shot the crew of an enemy machine gun, and, turning it on the enemy, enabled his party to reach the village. He then rushed another machine gun, killed the crew, captured an officer and 10 enemy, and thereby cleared the end of the village.

Lt. Algie, having established his party, went back for reinforcements, but was killed when leading them forward. His valour and personal initiative in the face of intense fire saved many lives and enabled the position to be held."

(London Gazette, no.31155, 31 January 1919)



The VC winner I have chosen to look at is Wallace Algie.

1. On Oct 11, 1918, he was able to take on an enemy machine-gun unit.
2. He was able to take over the unit allowing for his party to reach the village.
3. He was able to take another machine gun unit capturing an officer and 10 men.
4. Sadly he would be later killed in battle but his bravery saved many lives.

